8. HTML — Links, image maps, email, and iframes

Index: HTML tutorial
Previous: Lists
Next: Blocks

Text links

`<a>` with `href` is a link. The text inside the element is the label of the link.

href	Destination
`menu.html`	A file in the same folder
`pages/about.html`	A file in a subfolder
`../index.html`	A file in the parent folder
`https://www.python.org/`	Another site
`#hours`	The element with `id="hours"` on this page
`menu.html#breakfast`	An element on another page

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Link Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <a href="https://www.python.org/">Python</a>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Python

The target attribute

`target="_blank"` opens the link in a new browsing context. `rel="noopener noreferrer"` keeps that page from reaching back into this one. `target="_self"` opens it in the same context. That is the default.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
```

```
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Target Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <a href="https://www.python.org/" target="_blank" rel="noopener noreferrer">Python</a>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Python

Base path

`<base href>` in `<head>` sets the base URL for relative links on the page.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <base href="https://www.example.com/docs/">
  <title>Base Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <a href="start.html">Start</a>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Start

The visible label is Start. The address of the link is `https://www.example.com/docs/start.html`.

Linking to a page section

The value after `#` matches the `id` of an element, including letter case.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Page Section Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <a href="#hours">Hours</a>
```

```
  <h2 id="hours">Hours</h2>
  <p>Open until 8 pm.</p>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Hours

Hours

Open until 8 pm.

Download links

`download` asks the browser to download the file. A value sets the suggested file name.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Download Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <a href="files/menu.pdf" download="menu.pdf">Download the menu</a>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Download the menu

Image links

An image inside `<a>` is a link. `alt` still describes the image.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Image Link Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <a href="samosa.html">
    <img src="images/samosa.jpg" alt="Two samosas on a steel plate" width="320" height="240">
  </a>
```

```
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:



Image maps

`<map>` and `<area>` define regions of an image. `usemap` on `<img>` names the map. `shape` is `rect`, `circle`, or `poly`. `coords` lists the positions in pixels of the image. `alt` on each `<area>` names that region.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Image Map Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <img src="images/plan.jpg" alt="Floor plan of the canteen" usemap="#plan" width="320" height="200">
  <map name="plan">
    <area shape="rect" coords="10,10,150,190" href="counter.html" alt="Counter">
    <area shape="rect" coords="160,10,310,190" href="seating.html" alt="Seating">
  </map>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:



Email links

`mailto:` opens the visitor's email program. `subject`, `cc`, and `body` can be added as a query. A space in that query is written as `%20`.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Email Link Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <a href="mailto:placement@ksr.example?subject=Profile%20review&amp;body=Please%20review%20my%20profile
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Send a profile

Iframes

`<iframe>` shows another document in a rectangle on this page. `title` names the frame. `width` and `height` set the box. `name` is the target name other links can use. `sandbox` restricts the embedded document. An empty `sandbox` applies every restriction. `srcdoc` supplies the embedded document in the attribute itself.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Iframe Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <iframe
    title="Canteen note"
    width="400"
    height="120"
    sandbox=""
    srcdoc="<p>Counter is on the ground floor.</p>">
  </iframe>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Counter is on the ground floor.